☆親子の愛をめぐる、童話読切35ページ!

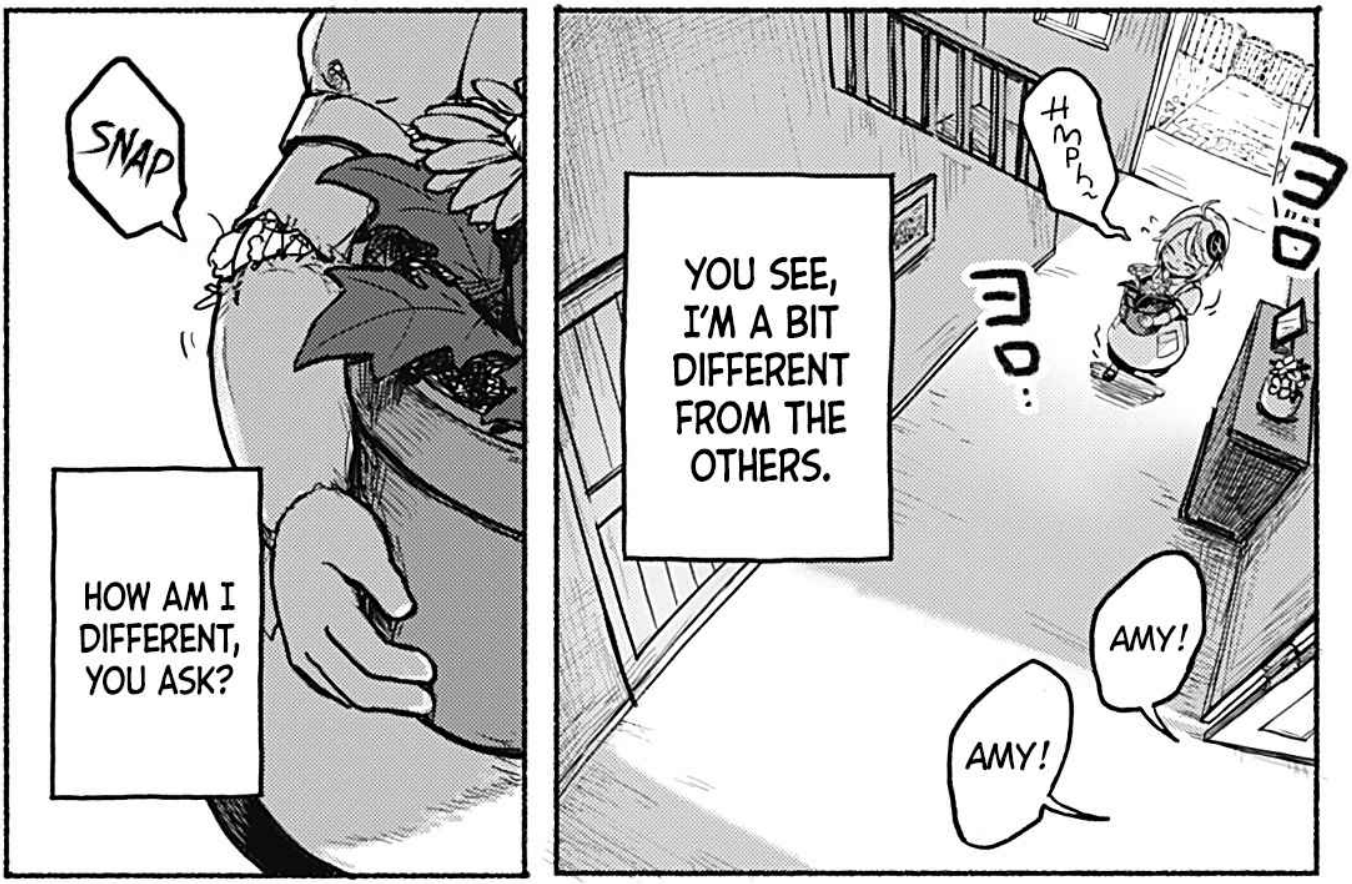


片腕のエイミー

人気イラストレーター、新作読切で再びJ+に登場!

紅木春

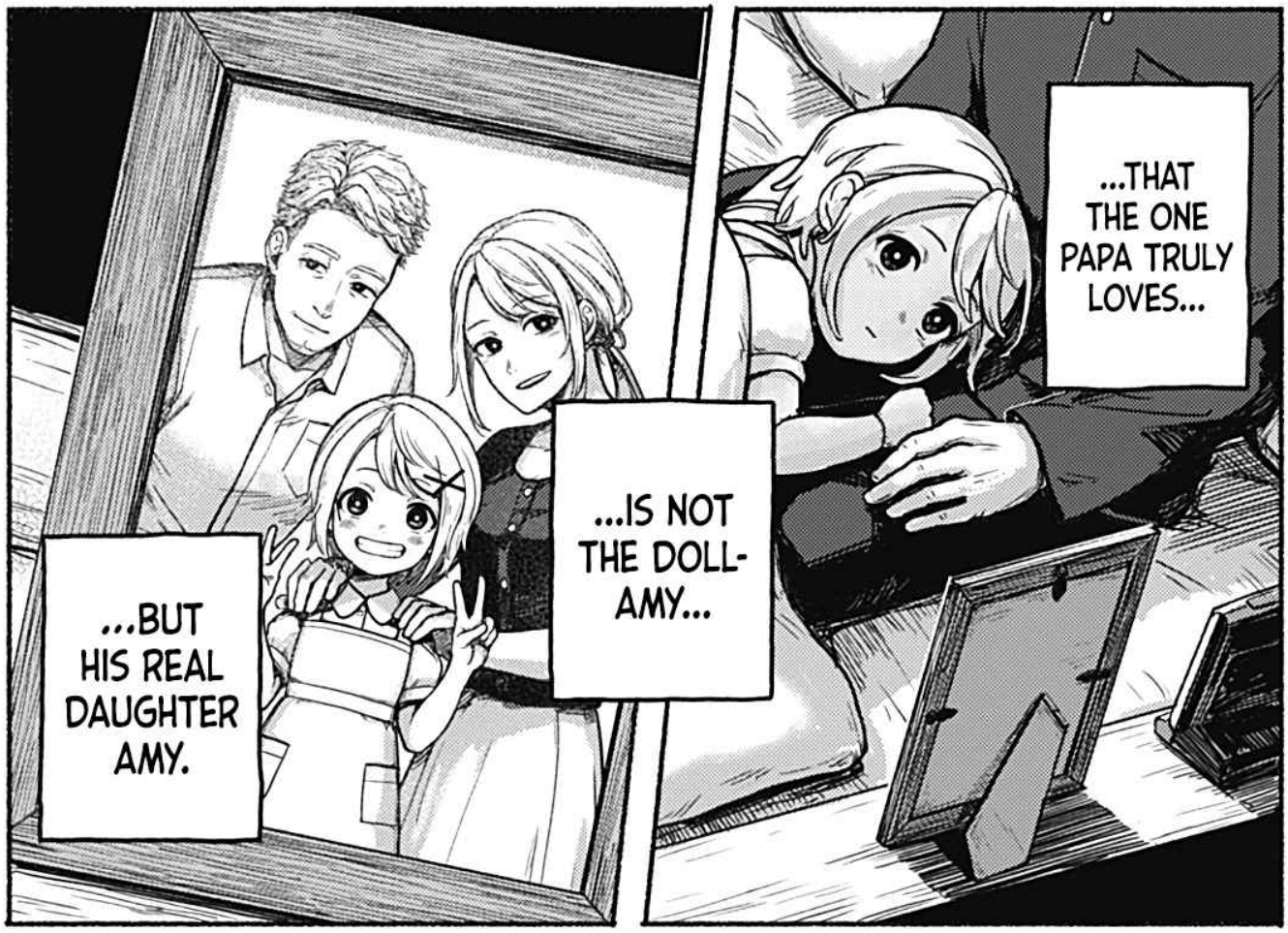

Oopsie-daisy!
MY NAME IS AMY!
I'M LIVING WITH MY PAPA, WHO I LOVE A LOT!
I'M JUST A LITTLE BIT OF A STRANGE GIRL!
THERE IS A SECRET TO THIS BRAVE GIRL...

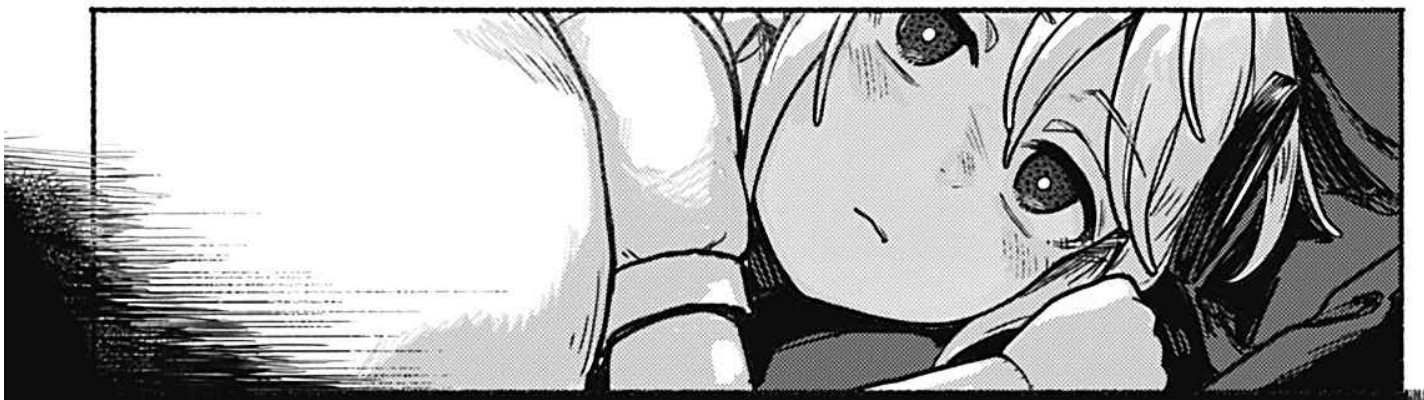

HMPh~
YOU SEE, I'M A BIT DIFFERENT FROM THE OTHERS.
AMY!
AMY!
SNAP
HOW AM I DIFFERENT, YOU ASK?

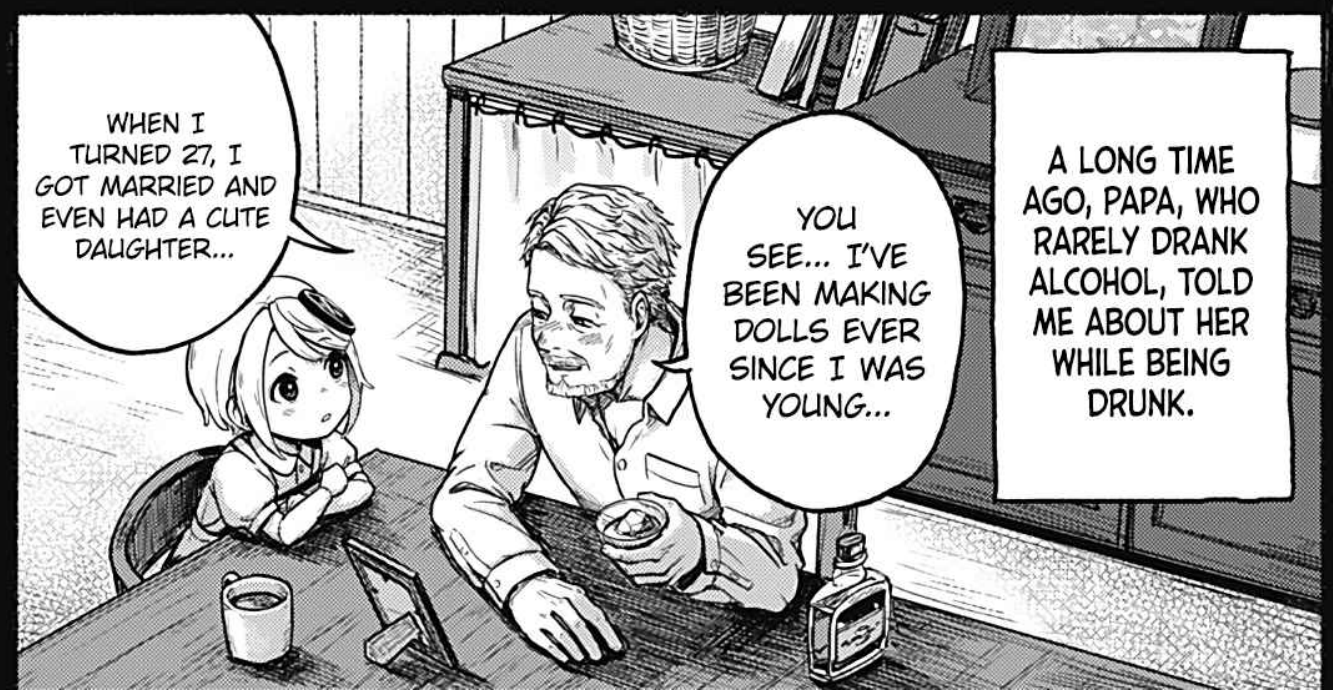

YES~!
フッ
ARARA...
IT FELL OFF AGAIN...
IT'S BECAUSE I'M A DOLL MADE OUT OF CLOTH AND THREAD.


NOT AGAIN... HOW MANY TIMES HAVE I TOLD YOU...
NOT TO CARRY HEAVY THINGS?
I'M SORRY...
But, you see!
I wanted to show you something!
Here!
This!
The flowers in the garden bloomed!
It's pretty!
ぴょんっ
AHH, I SEE.
THANK YOU, AMY.
ぴょんっ
PAPA IS VERY KIND!

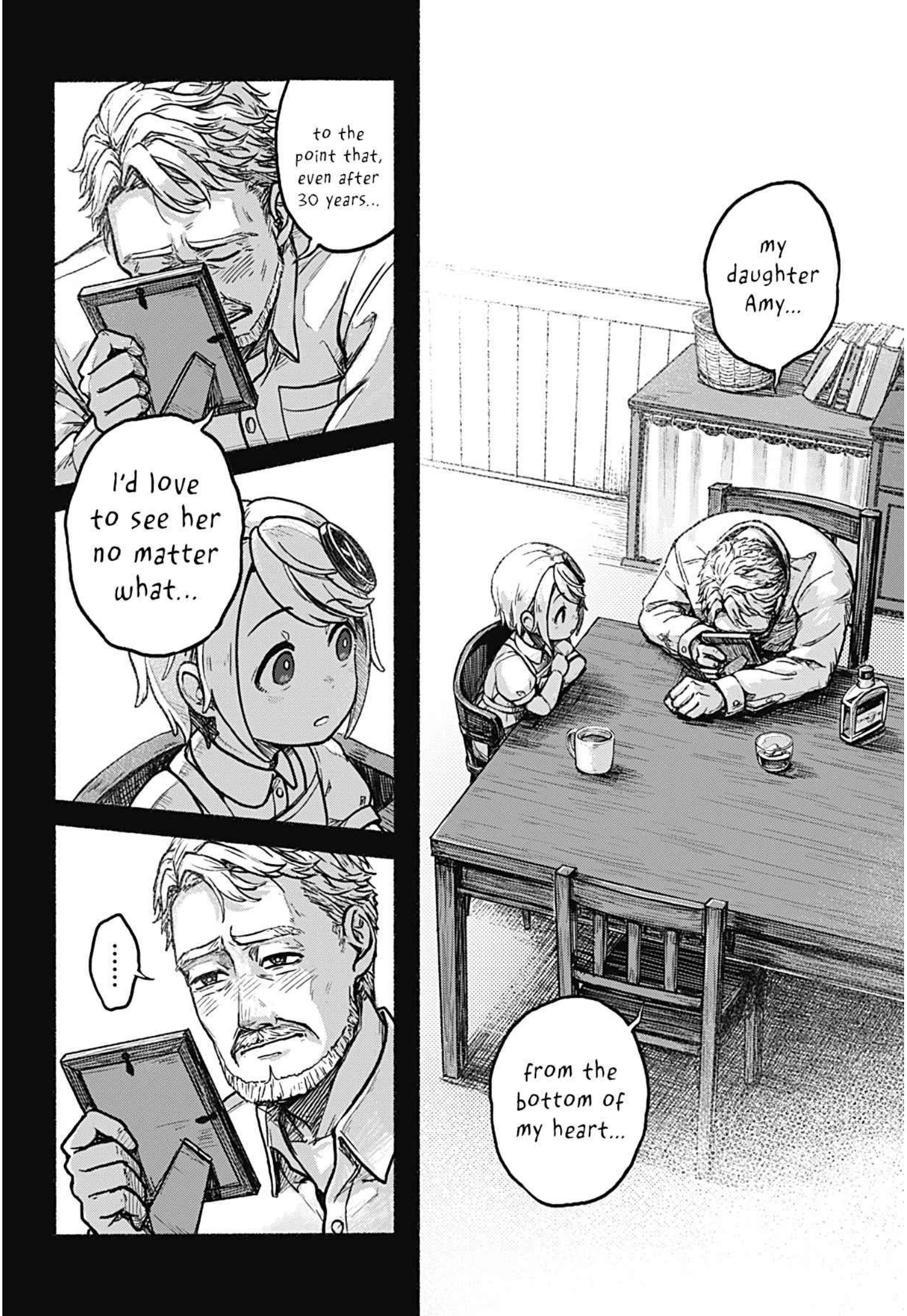

AND HE READS PICTURE BOOKS TO ME BEFORE BEDTIME!
CLEANS UP CLOTHES THAT GET MUDDY,
Waaah~
Not again!!
HE SOWS BACK THE ARM THAT FALLS OFF,
BUT I KNOW...
21:34
PAPA REALLY LOVES ME!
PAPA IS SO WARM...!

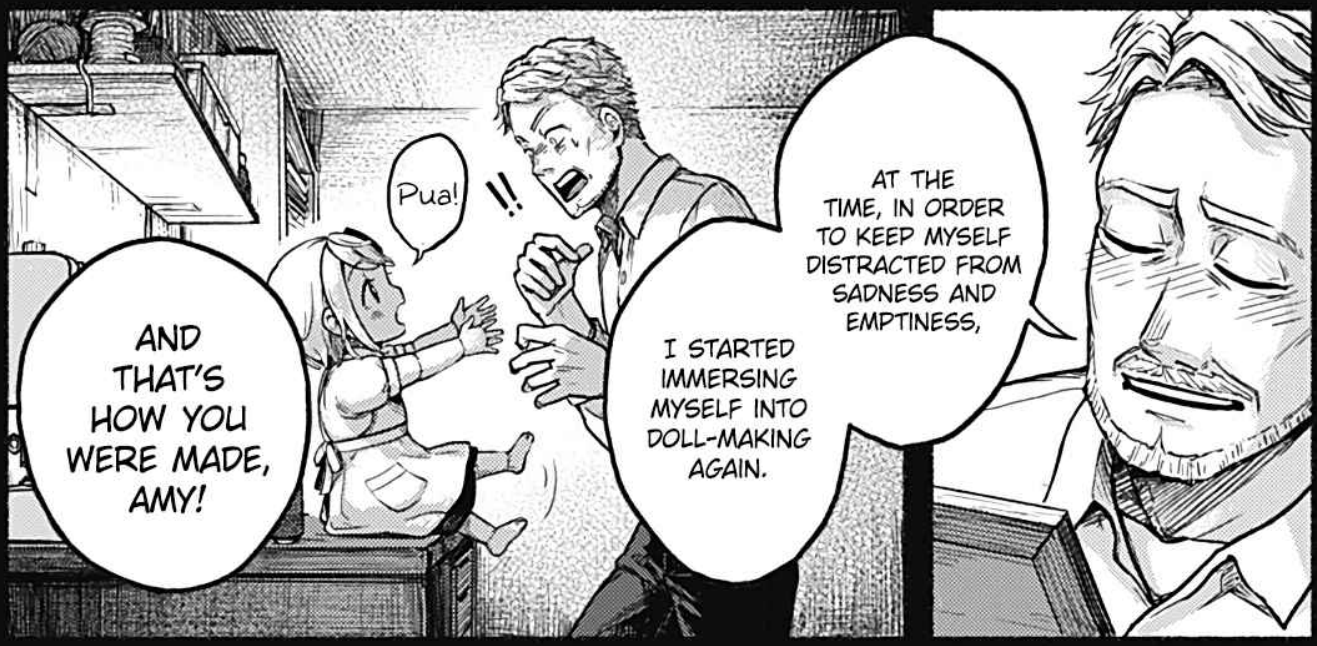

...THAT THE ONE PAPA TRULY LOVES...
...IS NOT THE DOLL-AMY...
...BUT HIS REAL DAUGHTER AMY.




A LONG TIME AGO, PAPA, WHO RARELY DRANK ALCOHOL, TOLD ME ABOUT HER WHILE BEING DRUNK.
YOU SEE... I'VE BEEN MAKING DOLLS EVER SINCE I WAS YOUNG...
WHEN I TURNED 27, I GOT MARRIED AND EVEN HAD A CUTE DAUGHTER...


BUT I WAS SO IMMERSED IN MY WORK THAT I DID NOT PAY ATTENTION TO MY SURROUNDINGS...
I MUST HAVE BEEN PUNISHED FOR THAT.
WHEN MY DAUGHTER TURNED 5, MY WIFE TOOK HER AND LEFT THE HOUSE...
...PAPA, WERE YOU SAD...?
...YES, VERY MUCH SO.
I FINALLY REALIZED IT AFTER LOSING THEM.
I'VE ALWAYS FOUGHT WITH MY WIFE...
BUT THINKING ABOUT IT NOW, SHE WAS A GREAT WIFE THAT I DID NOT DESERVE.
I... love...


my daughter Amy...
from the bottom of my heart...
to the point that, even after 30 years...
I'd love to see her no matter what...
.....


Pua!
!!
AND THAT'S HOW YOU WERE MADE, AMY!
I STARTED IMMERSING MYSELF INTO DOLL-MAKING AGAIN.
AT THE TIME, IN ORDER TO KEEP MYSELF DISTRACTED FROM SADNESS AND EMPTINESS,


THANKS TO YOU, I DID NOT HAVE THE TIME TO BE GETTING BORED OVER THE LAST 30 YEARS.


Amy! Miracle child!
THIS IS A MIRACLE!
HAHAH... YES, MIRACLE DOLL, INDEED...


PAPA SMILES A LOT, BUT...


AH, YES YOU ARE A REALLY GOOD GIRL.
IS AMY GOOD? IS SHE!?


HE MUST BE VERY SAD...
IN TRUTH,
DO YOU NOT KNOW WHERE THE REAL AMY LIVES...?
...NO, I BELIEVE THE ADDRESS WAS SOMEWHERE HERE...
Papa! Hey Papa! Let's go see her!
The real Amy!
EHHH!?
No, but... That's...
W- WE CAN'T! I CAN'T SEE MY DAUGHTER ANYMORE!
Let's go! Let's go!
IT CAME ABOUT 2 YEARS AGO...
...THIS IS MY WIFE'S OBITUARY LETTER.
WHAT IS THIS?


I DON'T HAVE THE FACE TO MEET MY DAUGHTER ANYMORE...
WHY NOT...?
.....
HAHAHA, I'M FINE.
ARE YOU LACKING IN PARTS?
?
FACE...? BUT PAPA HAS A FACE ATTACHED TO HIM?
I WISH I WERE THE REAL AMY...
I HAVE ALL THE PARTS I NEED.


EVEN THOUGH I'M BY HIS SIDE ALL THE TIME,
I will carry some too~!
THIS IS HEAVY, SO YOU CAN'T.


...AM I USELESS?
……

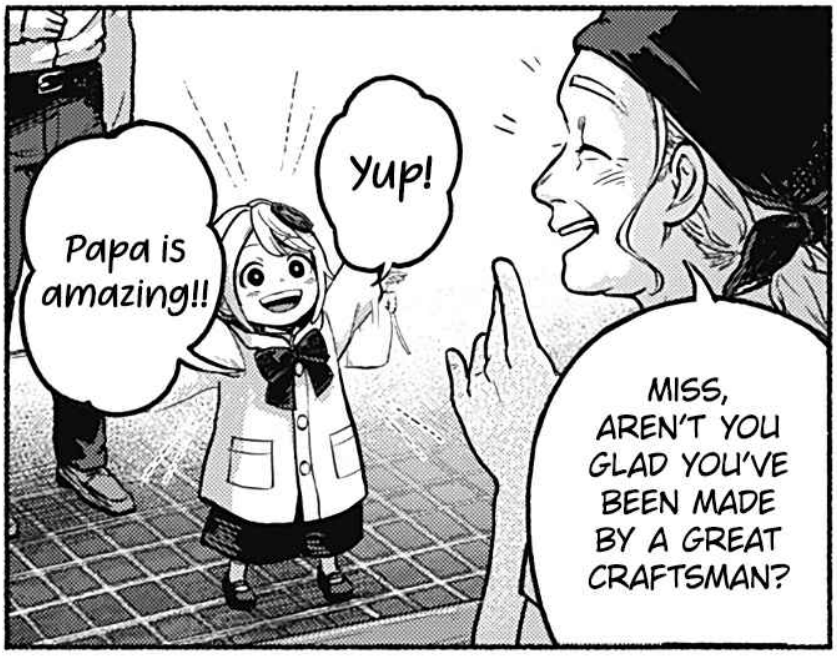

I'LL TAKE THIS RED ONE...
THANKS!

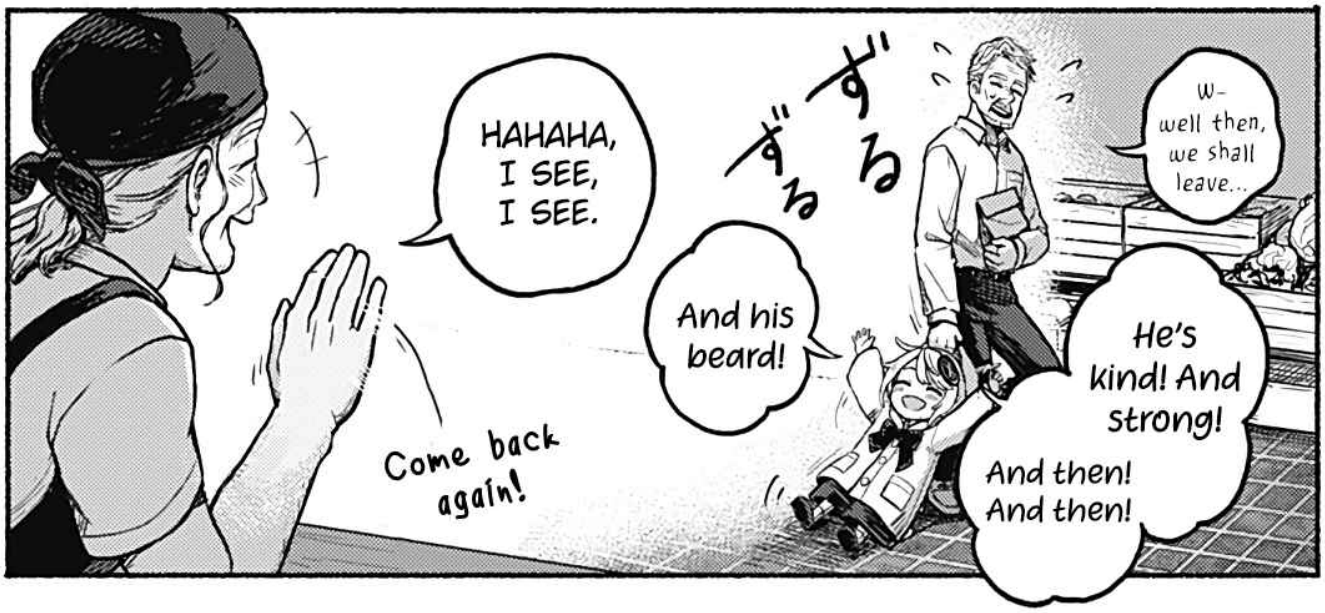

AS THE DOLL AMY, I CAN'T WIN AGAINST THE REAL AMY.


!
Yes! I will!
HOP
AMY, CAN YOU CARRY THIS ONE FOR ME?
OH?
TOMATO
...UM.
WELL...
IS SHE, BY ANY CHANCE, A DOLL?
I'M NOT.
EVEN THOUGH IT'S A COMMON SIGHT THESE DAYS...
ARE YOU... AFRAID OF ME?


A LONG TIME AGO, IN THIS COUNTRY,
THERE WERE CRAFTSMEN THAT PUT SO MUCH EFFORT INTO THEIR PRODUCT...
THAT A SOUL WAS EMBEDDED INTO IT.

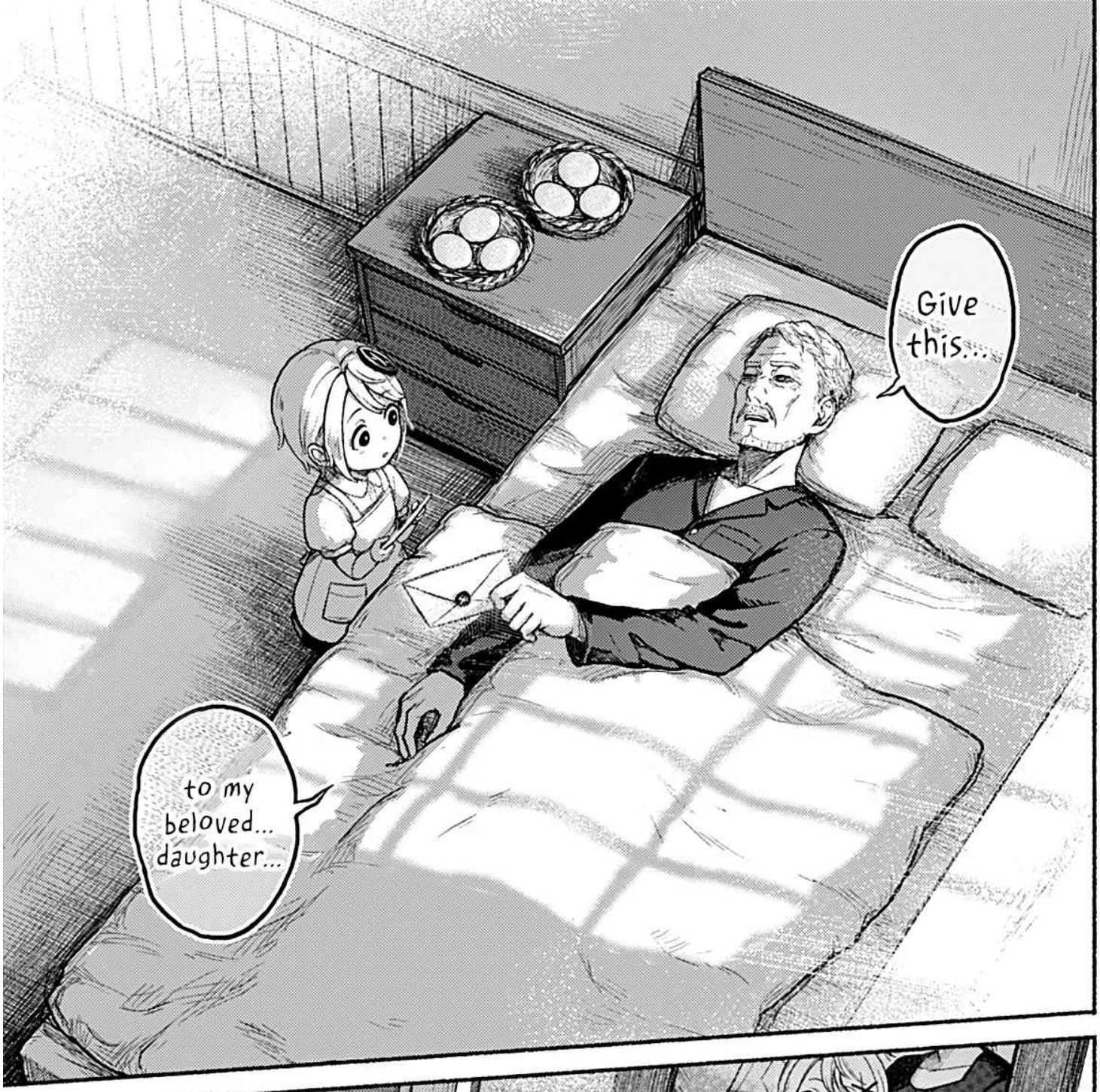

He always fixes me,
hugs me,
and he's warm, like the sun!


MISS, AREN'T YOU GLAD YOU'VE BEEN MADE BY A GREAT CRAFTSMAN?
Yup!
Papa is amazing!!


HAHAHA, I SEE, I SEE.
Come back again!
And his beard!
ずる
ずる
W-well then, we shall leave...
He's kind! And strong!
And then! And then!

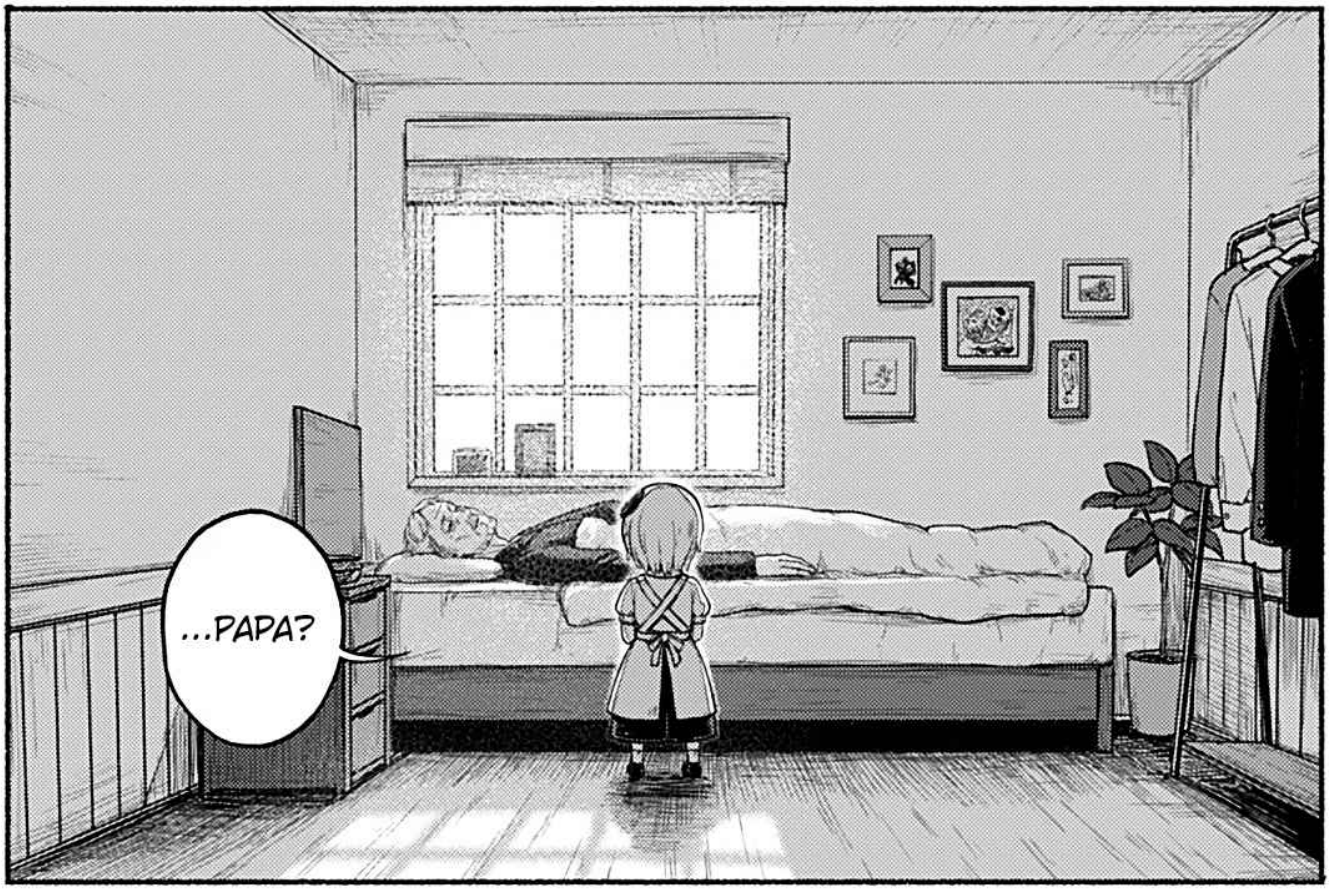

HALF A YEAR LATER...
ゲホッ ゲホッ...
PAPA BECAME UNABLE TO LEAVE THE BED.
PAPA, I BROUGHT SOME FOOD!
... Thank... y-
ゲホッ
...Thank you... Amy.
Amy...
take... this...

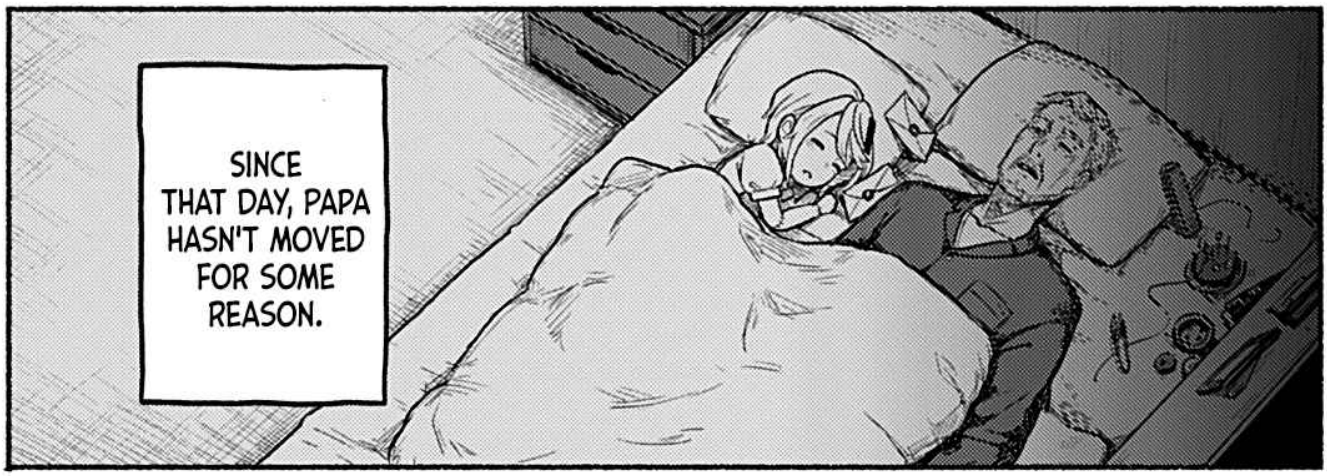

...A letter.
THIS IS...?
!
Yes, that's right...
THIS IS MY FIRST TIME DELIVERING LETTERS!
SHOULD I DELIVER THIS TO THE AUNTIE AT THE FLOWER SHOP?
Lady...
Give this... to the usual flower shop...
A...
my...
Also...
One more letter...

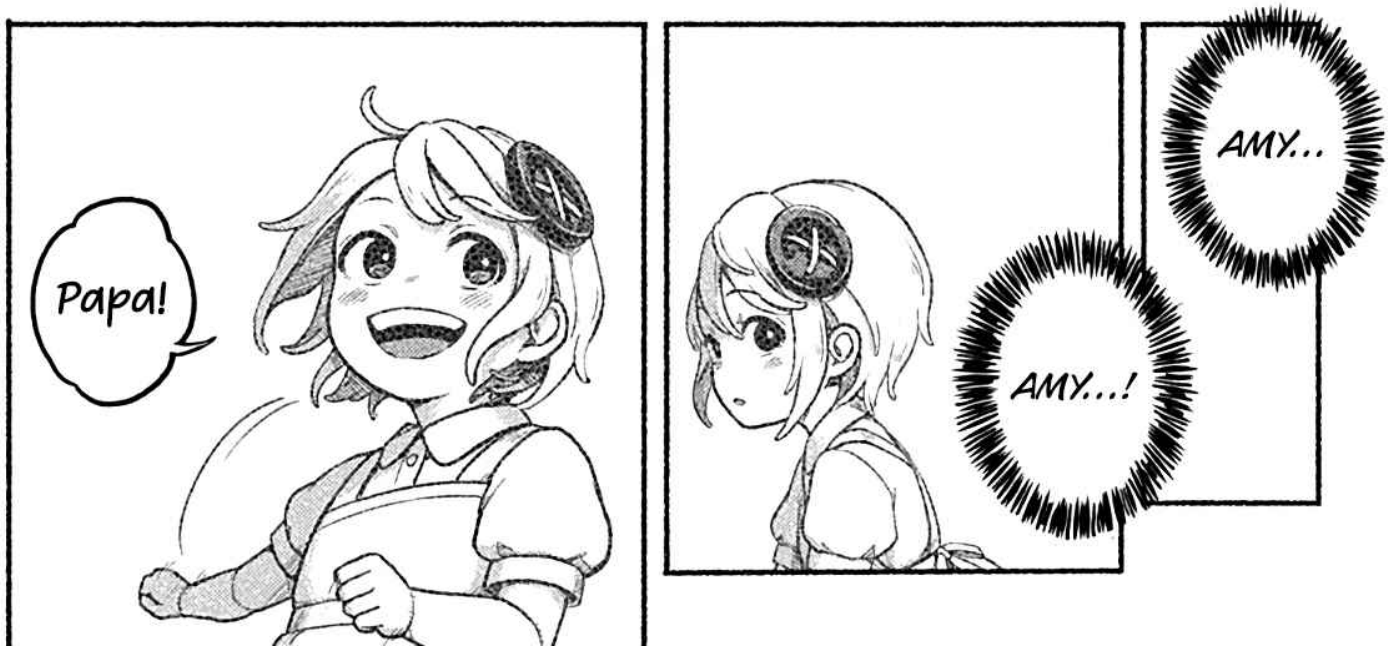

Give this...
to my beloved... daughter...




PAPA...

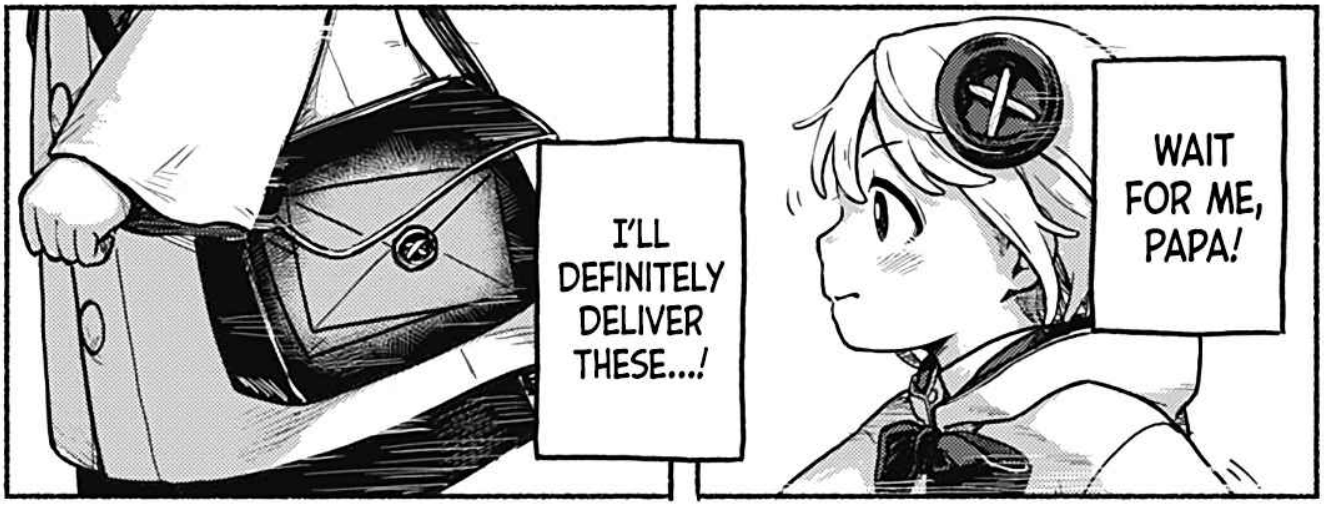

...PAPA?

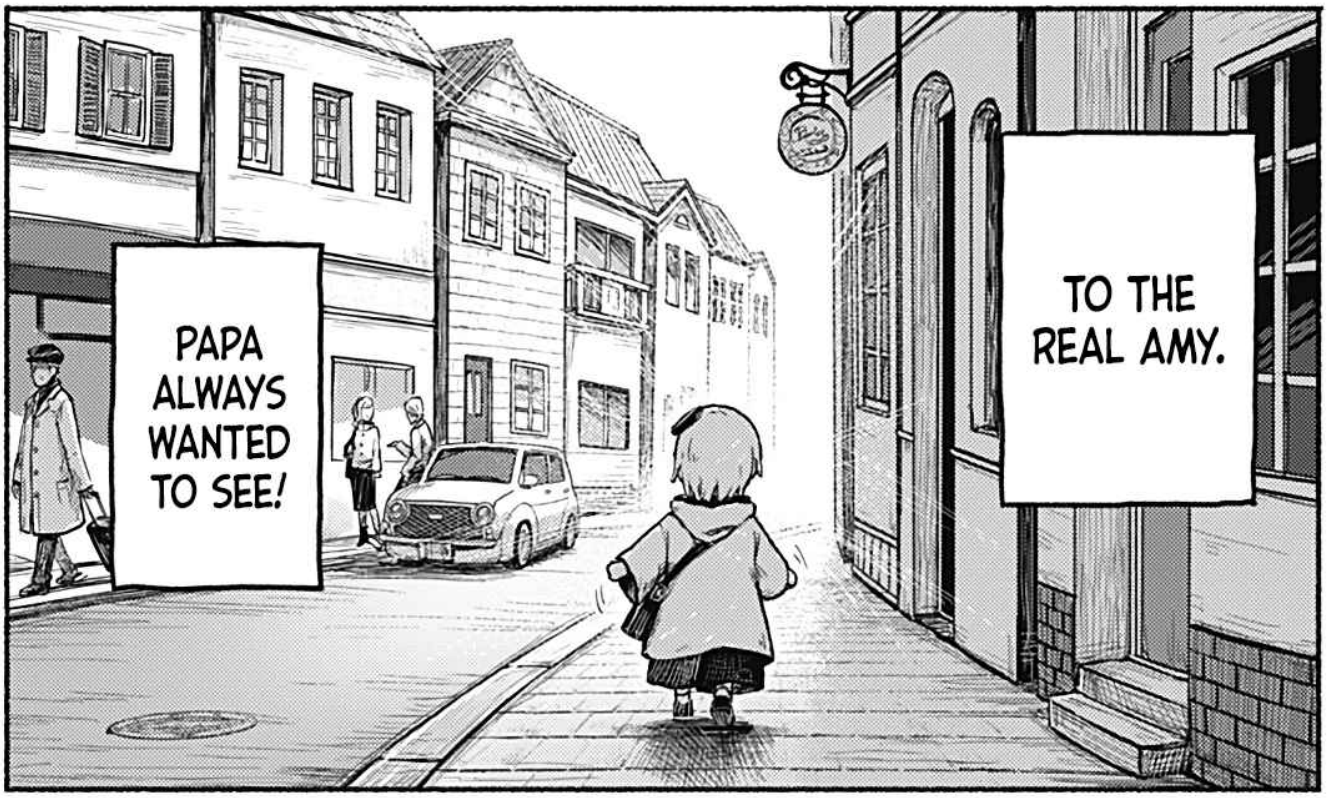

SINCE THAT DAY, PAPA HASN'T MOVED FOR SOME REASON.


Papa!
AMY...!
AMY...

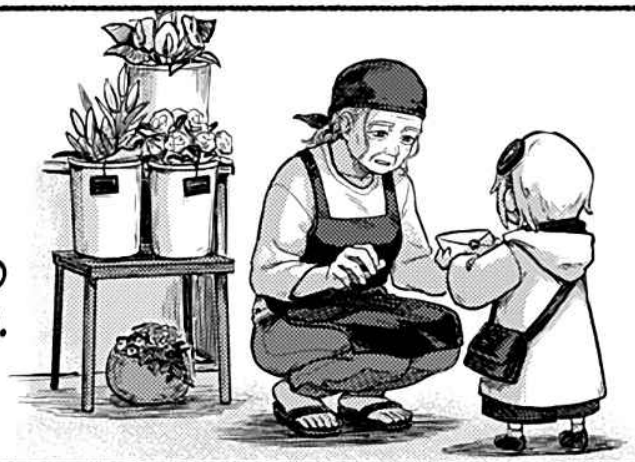

はっ
PAPA...
I'VE AL-WAYS...
WANTED TO MEET THE REAL YOU, AMY!
BRING THIS... TO MY BELOVED DAUGHTER...
...I SHOULD DELIVER THESE.
ダッ
ばっ
...I SHOULD DELIVER THESE!


THE NEXT DAY, FOR THE FIRST TIME,
I'VE LEFT THE HOUSE ON MY OWN.
Well then, let's go!


WAIT FOR ME, PAPA!
I'LL DEFINITELY DELIVER THESE...!


TO THE REAL AMY.
PAPA ALWAYS WANTED TO SEE!

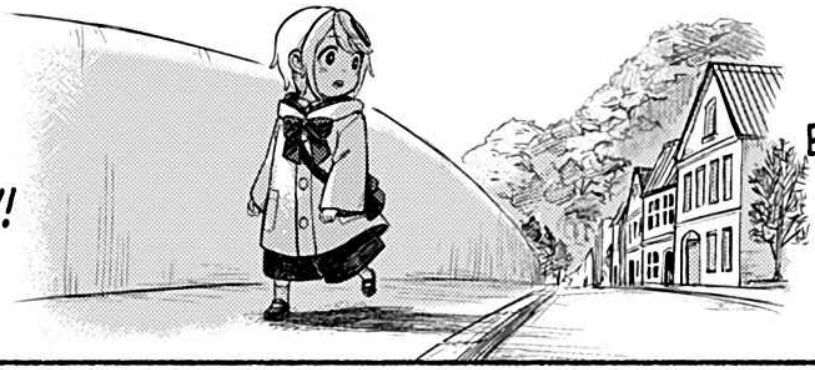
AUNTIE STARED AT THE LETTER FOR A WHILE AND PATTED MY HEAD.



DAY 1

I DELIVERED THE LETTER TO THE FLOWER SHOP AUNTIE.

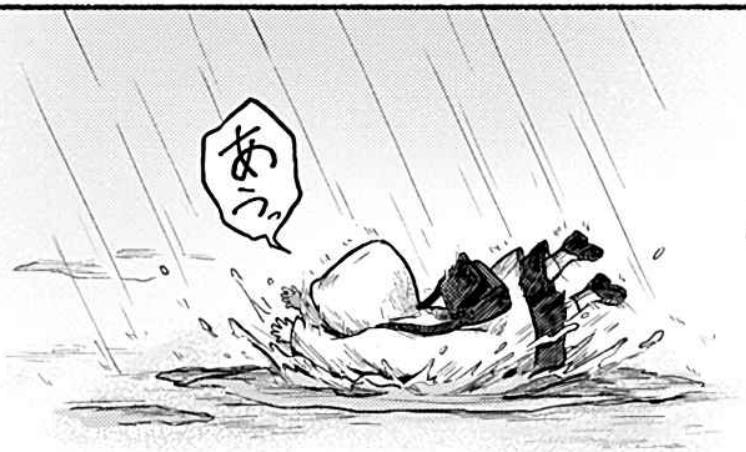
WAIT FOR ME, REAL AMY!



DAY 3

I'VE NEVER BEEN THIS FAR FROM HOME BEFORE!

BUT THE LETTER DIDN'T GET WET WHAT A RELIEF!



DAY 7

MY CLOTHES GOT DIRTY.

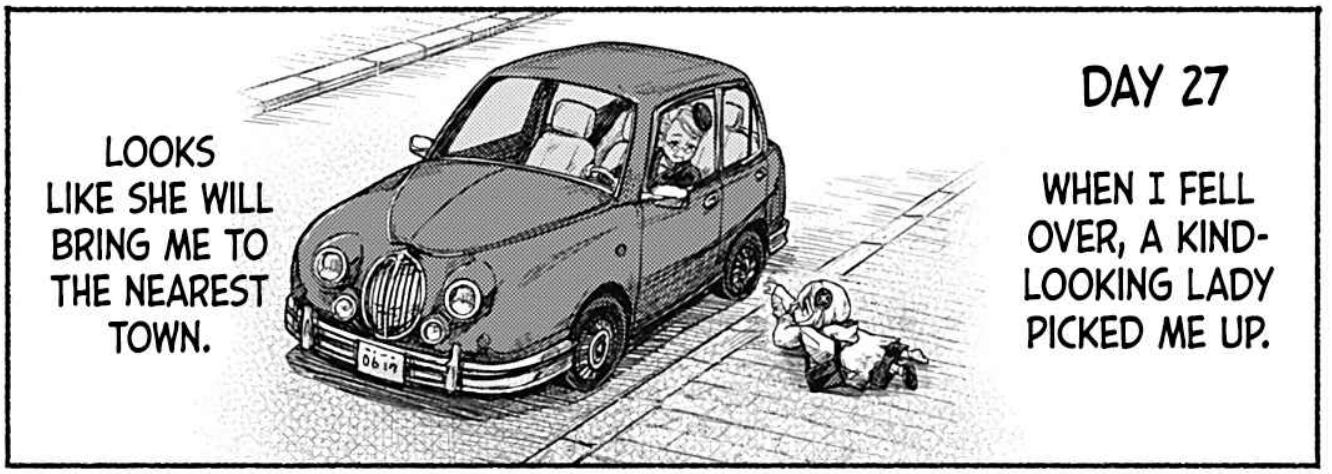
IT WAS MY FAVOURITE COAT, I GOT IT FROM PAPA AS A BIRTHDAY PRESENT.



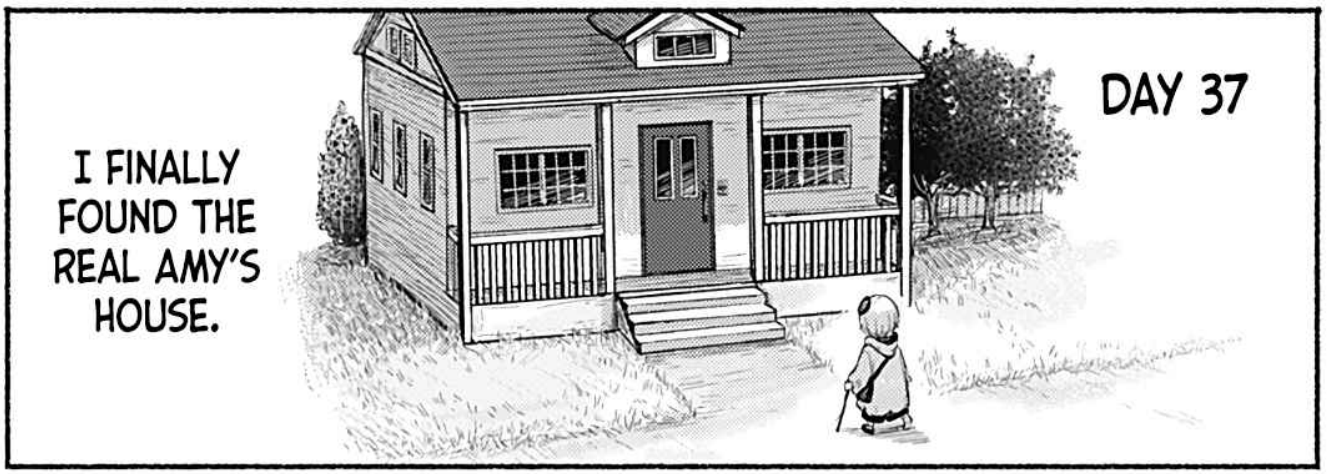
DAY 14

MY COAT GOT TATTERED.

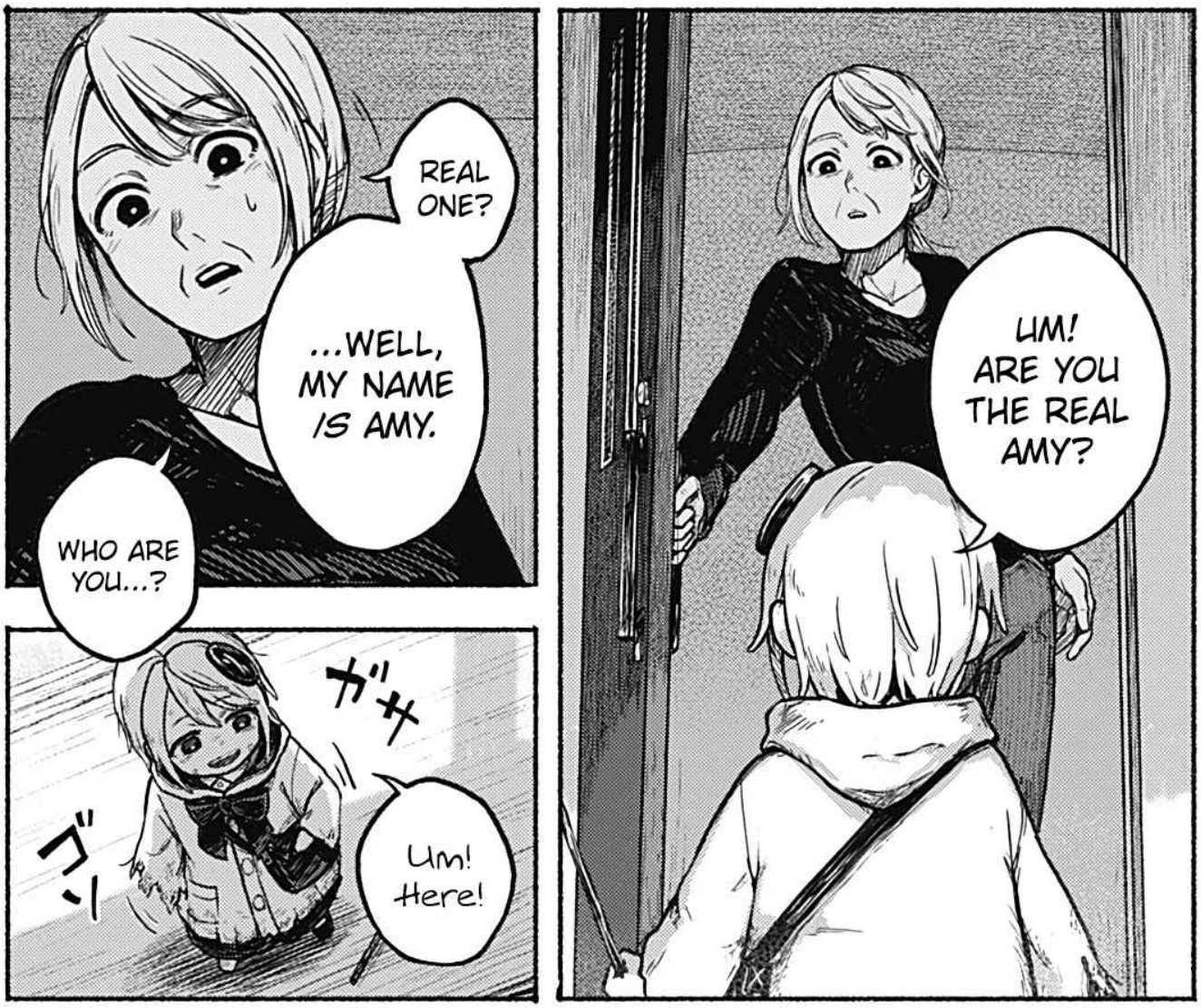

MY BODY IS GETTING STIFFER AND HEAVIER.
DAY 18
I LOST SHOES FOR MY ARTIFICIAL FEET.


LOOKS LIKE SHE WILL BRING ME TO THE NEAREST TOWN.
DAY 27
WHEN I FELL OVER, A KIND-LOOKING LADY PICKED ME UP.


I'M GLAD IT WASN'T MY LEG THAT CAME OFF... I CAN STILL WALK...
I NO LONGER HAVE PAPA TO PUT THEM BACK ON.
DAY 32
MY RIGHT ARM FINALLY FELL OFF.


I FINALLY FOUND THE REAL AMY'S HOUSE.
DAY 37

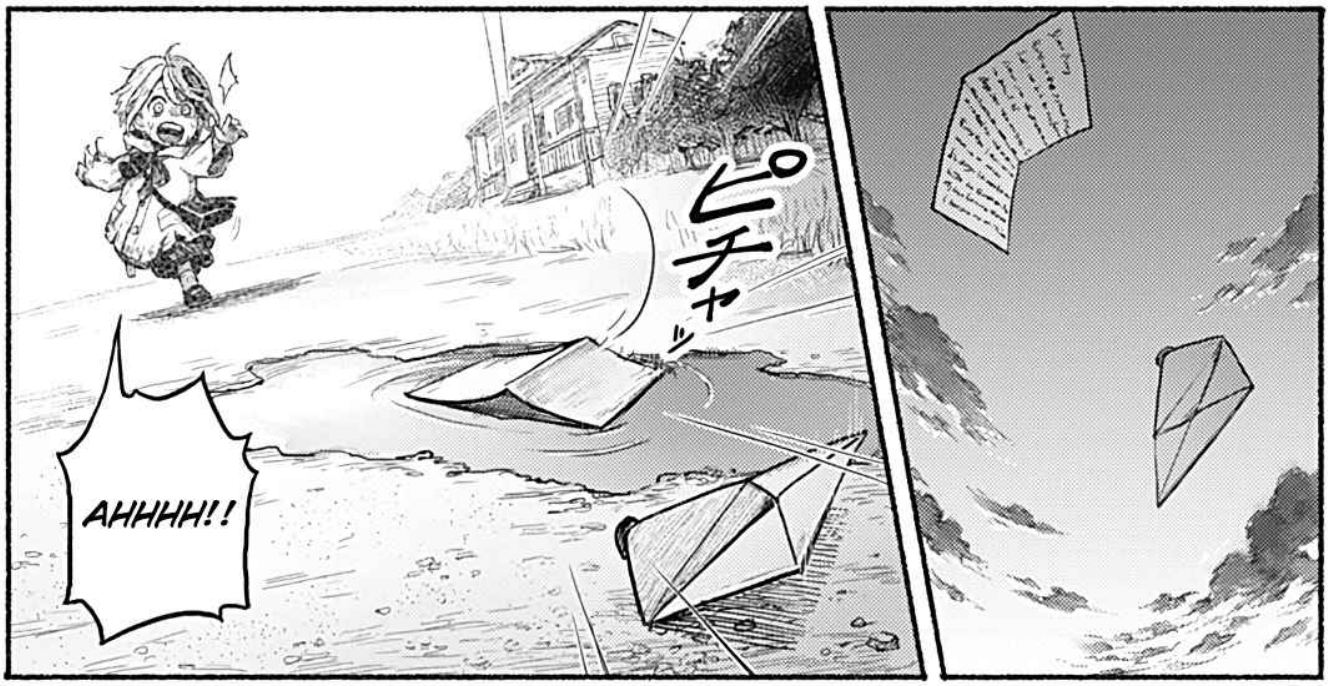

I GOT-TA HURRY AND LET THE REAL AMY KNOW...!
ABOUT HOW MUCH PAPA, LOVED HER...!
DING DONG

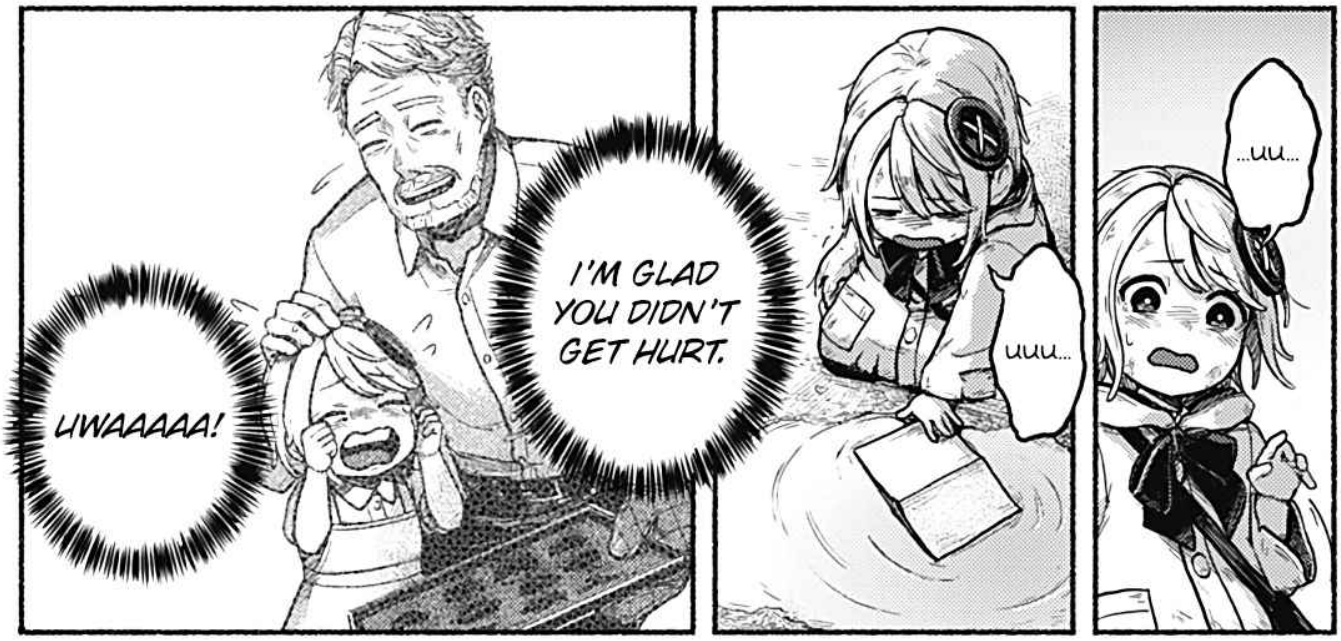

UM! ARE YOU THE REAL AMY?
REAL ONE?
...WELL, MY NAME IS AMY.
WHO ARE YOU...?
ガサ
ゴソ
Um! Here!

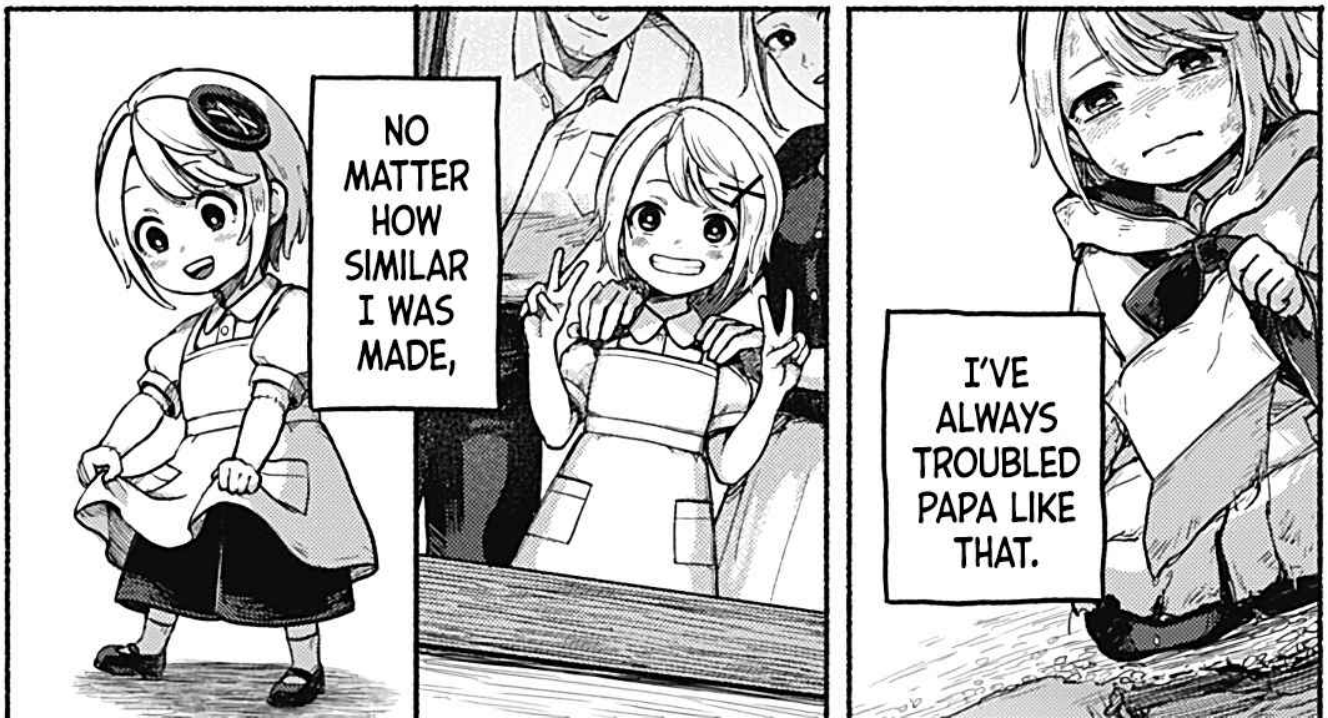

A letter from Amy's Papa!
...WHAT?
I DON'T HAVE ANYONE I CAN CALL PAPA.
IF THIS IS A PRANK, PLEASE LEAVE.

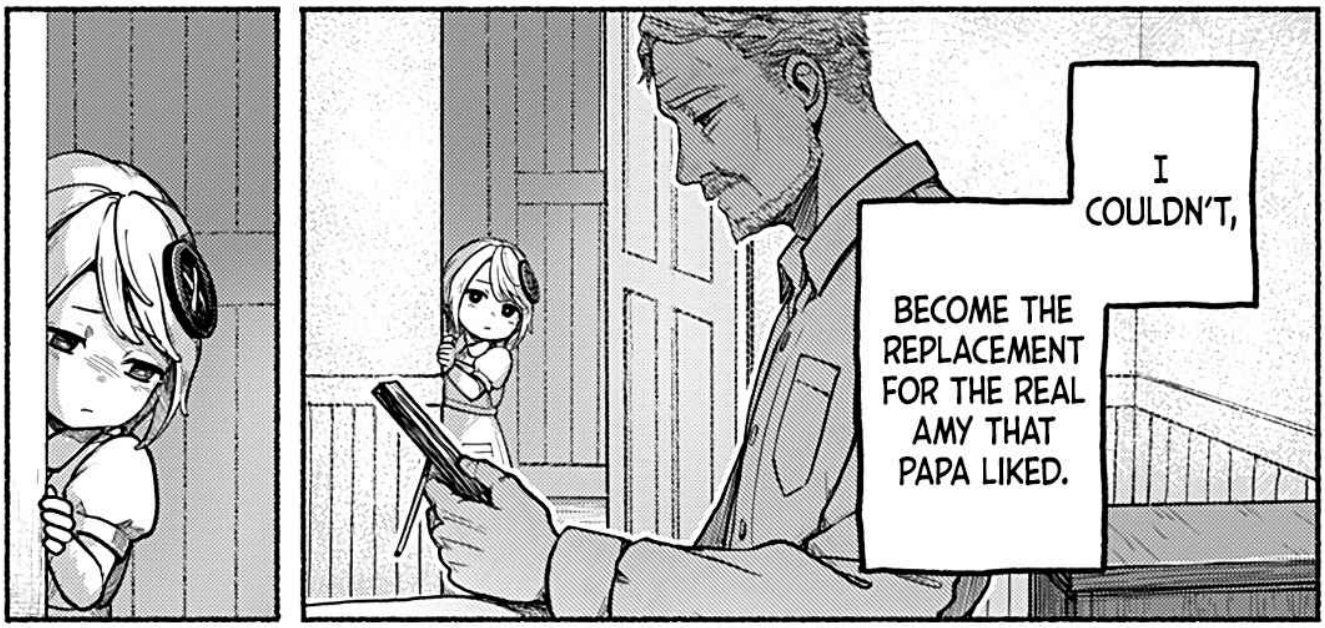

……
DING DONG
DING DONG
ガチャ
……
IT'S FROM PAPA! IT'S A VERY IMPORTANT LETTER!
SO ANNOY-ING!

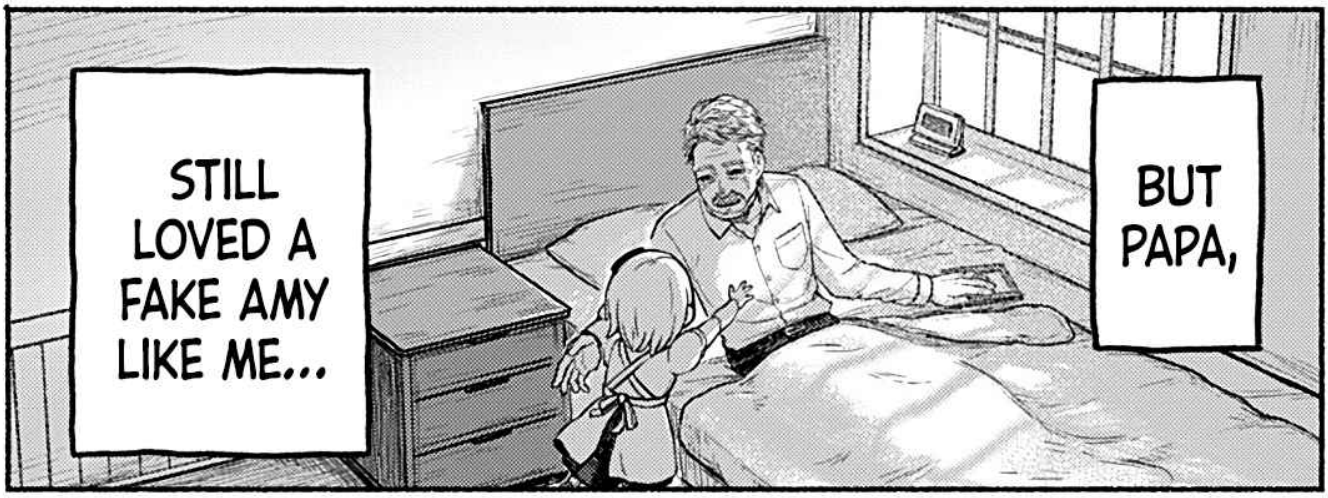

AH!
Papa...
I SAID WAIT!
WAIT!


AHHHH!!
ピチャ


UWAAAAA!
I'M GLAD YOU DIDN'T GET HURT.
UUU...
...UU...


NO MATTER HOW SIMILAR I WAS MADE,
I'VE ALWAYS TROUBLED PAPA LIKE THAT.


I COULDN'T,
BECOME THE REPLACEMENT FOR THE REAL AMY THAT PAPA LIKED.


STILL LOVED A FAKE AMY LIKE ME...
BUT PAPA,

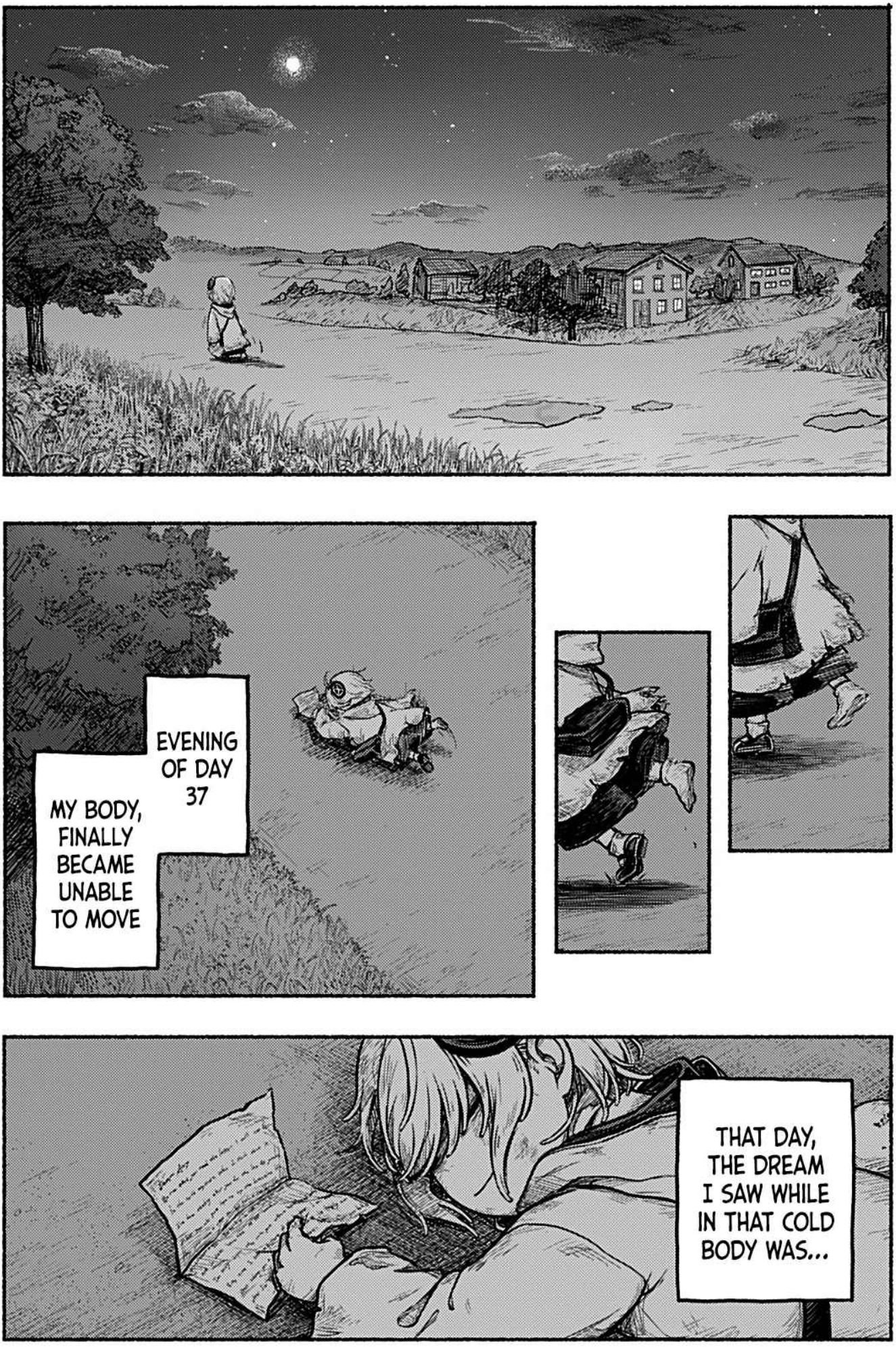

I WANTED TO DELIVER THIS LETTER...!!
uwaa...
uu...
SO AT THE VERY LEAST...
nn...

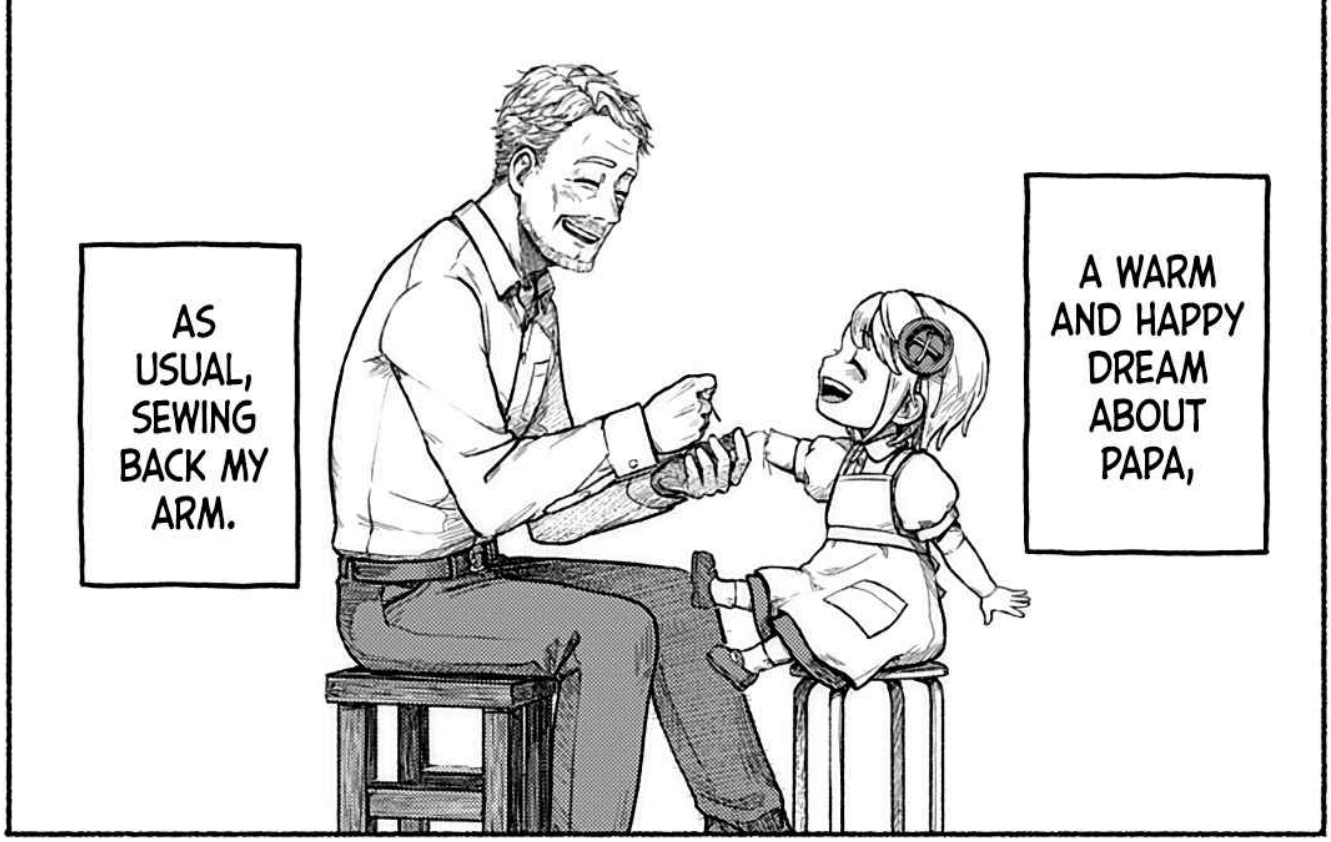

BY THE TIME YOU READ THIS LETTER, I WOULD NO LONGER BE IN THIS WORLD.
AMY.
PAPA'S LETTER IS ALREADY MESSY...
I'VE ALWAYS THOUGHT ABOUT YOU AS I LIVED ON.
IF I THINK ABOUT IT, OVER THE LAST 40 YEARS,
TO MY ROCK BOTTOM LIFE.
YOU, WHO GAVE A LIGHT

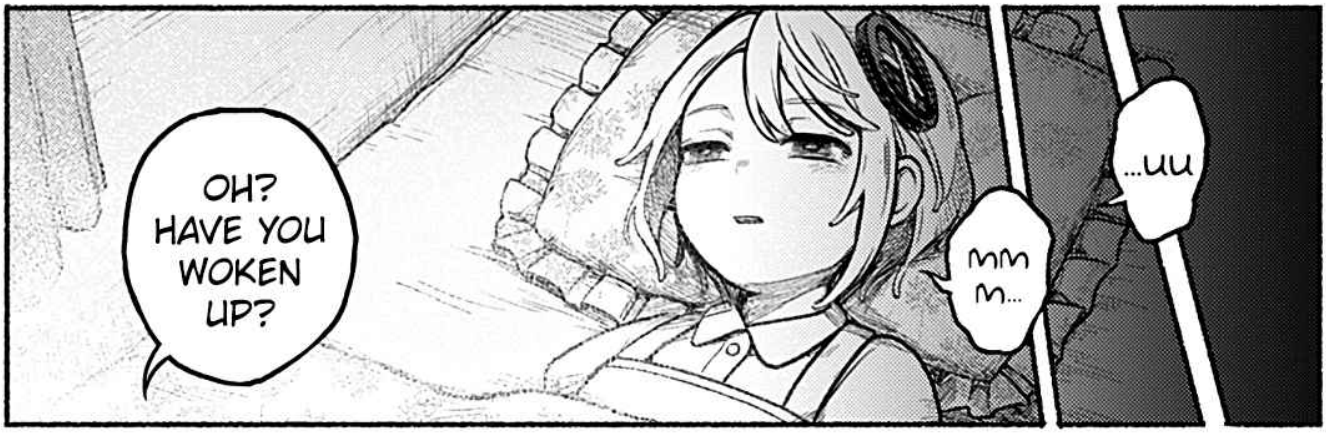

……!
THIS IS...
AMY, YOU ARE A VERY SPOILED CHILD.
YOU ARE A NAUGHTY AND TROU-BLESOME CHILD,
BUT EVERYDAY I SPENT WITH YOU WAS FUN, AND THERE WAS NO TIME TO BE BORED.
I APOLOGIZE FOR ONLY BEING ABLE TO MAKE YOU OUT OF A CONSTRAINING BODY.
I WISH FOR YOU TO LIVE HAPPILY EVEN AFTER I HAVE DIS-APPEARED.
EVERY TIME I SAW MY DAUGHTER'S PICTURE, THE ONLY THING I COULD THINK OF WAS,
"I WISH I COULD MAKE HER INTO A REAL HUMAN..."

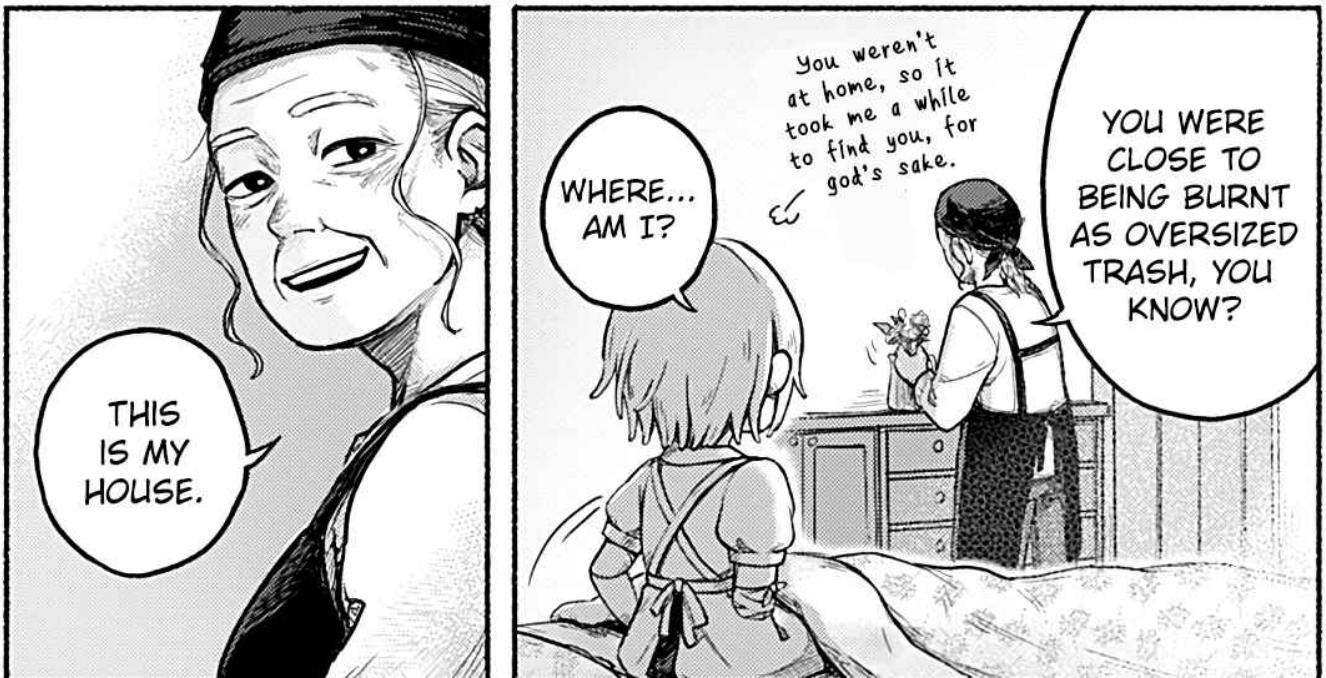

MY OTHER DAUGHTER,
I LOVE YOU,
AMY.
nn...
Amy was...
Amy...

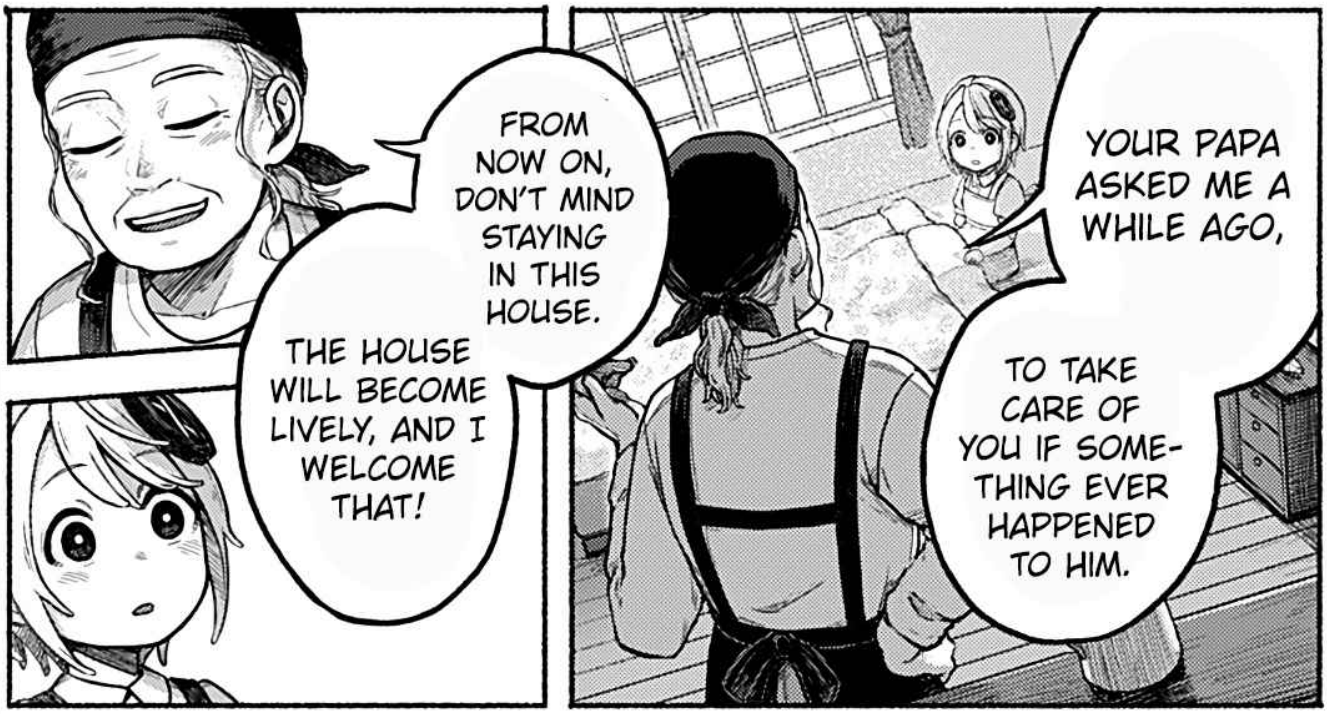

愛されていた…!!
LOVED PROPERLY...!!
Uuu waa...
Uuu uwa aa...!!

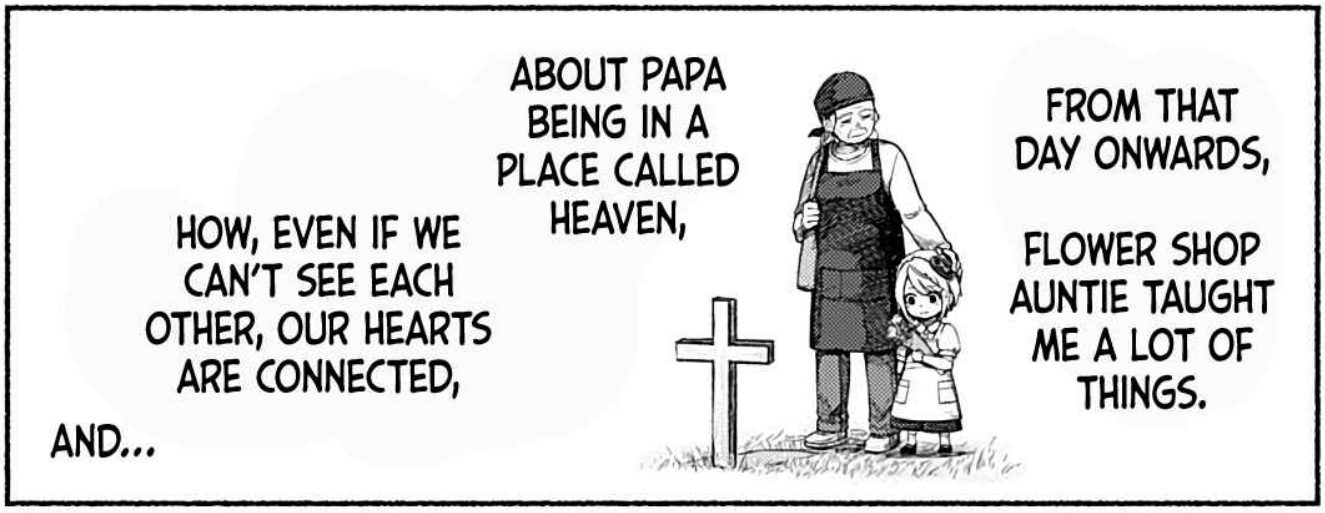

EVENING OF DAY 37
MY BODY, FINALLY BECAME UNABLE TO MOVE
THAT DAY, THE DREAM I SAW WHILE IN THAT COLD BODY WAS...


AS USUAL, SEWING BACK MY ARM.
A WARM AND HAPPY DREAM ABOUT PAPA,


OH? HAVE YOU WOKEN UP?
mm m...
...uu


THIS IS MY HOUSE.
WHERE... AM I?
You weren't at home, so it took me a while to find you, for god's sake.
YOU WERE CLOSE TO BEING BURNT AS OVERSIZED TRASH, YOU KNOW?


YOUR PAPA ASKED ME A WHILE AGO,
TO TAKE CARE OF YOU IF SOMETHING EVER HAPPENED TO HIM.
FROM NOW ON, DON'T MIND STAYING IN THIS HOUSE.
THE HOUSE WILL BECOME LIVELY, AND I WELCOME THAT!


FROM THAT DAY ONWARDS,
FLOWER SHOP AUNTIE TAUGHT ME A LOT OF THINGS.
ABOUT PAPA BEING IN A PLACE CALLED HEAVEN,
HOW, EVEN IF WE CAN'T SEE EACH OTHER, OUR HEARTS ARE CONNECTED,
AND...


To Papa in heaven, Amy is happy right now! Amy
HOW TO WRITE A LETTER TO LOVED ONES.
ONE-ARMED AMY... FIN.